



NORTH MIDDLESEX REGIONAL SCHOOL DISTRICT
FINANCE SUBCOMMITTEE
Ashby – Pepperell – Townsend, Massachusetts

NOTICE OF PUBLIC MEETING

Date of Meeting: **December 1, 2025**

Time of Meeting: **8:30 a.m.**

Day of the Week: Monday

Join Zoom Meeting: <https://zoom.us/j/95776487497?pwd=J1aEIVJaaAg7apDzuMOteko1MRHPAv.1>

Passcode: 885912

Join via audio:

📞 +1 305 224 1968 US, 📞 +1 309 205 3325 US, 📞 +1 360 209 5623 US, 📞 +1 386 347 5053 US, 📞 +1 507 473 4847 US, 📞 +1 564 217 2000 US, 📞 +1 669 444 9171 US, 📞 +1 689 278 1000 US, 📞 +1 719 359 4580 US
📞 +1 253 205 0468 US

Webinar ID: 957 7648 7497 Passcode: 885912

	AGENDA	
8:30	CALL TO ORDER	
8:30	APPROVAL OF MINUTES – VOTES MAY BE TAKEN October 30, 2025	ACTION
8:30	PUBLIC COMMENT	
8:35	OLD BUSINESS – VOTES MAY BE TAKEN - FY26 Budget - Year to date Spending - Unforeseen Changes - FY27 Budget Planning - Review Budget Meeting with TA's, BOS, and FinCom Members - Review Handouts from Pepperell TA - Review Current Staffing - DIB Fiscal Reserve Policy	ACTION
9:25	NEW BUSINESS – VOTES MAY BE TAKEN	ACTION

OUR MISSION: At NM, we are committed to creating a diverse learning environment where students are provided a meaningful education through academic, social, and emotional learning experiences. Together with parents, caregivers, and the community, students are encouraged to ignite and embrace their individual potential to find success within NM and beyond.

9:25	FUTURE MEETING – VOTES MAY BE TAKEN	ACTION
9:25	OTHER BUSINESS NOT REASONABLY ANTICIPATED – VOTES MAY BE TAKEN	ACTION
9:25	PUBLIC COMMENT	
9:30	ADJOURNMENT	ACTION
	NOTE: The listing of matters is those reasonably anticipated by the Chair, which may be discussed at the meeting. Not all items listed may be discussed and other items not listed may also be brought up for discussion to the extent permitted by law.	
	MEETING PACKET 2025 12-01 Finance Packet	

In accordance with the **Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)**, please contact Dr. Burboa-Reese at 978-597-8713 ext. 1300 or email info@nmrsd.org if you require accommodations to participate in this meeting. We are committed to ensuring accessibility for all members of our community.

Posted: November 21, 2025, at 1:30 p.m.



NORTH MIDDLESEX REGIONAL SCHOOL DISTRICT FINANCE COMMITTEE

Ashby – Pepperell – Townsend, Massachusetts

MINUTES – October 2, 2025

Virtual via Zoom

PRESENT

Chairperson

Kym Craven
Lisa Martin
Patrick McPhillips
Qenan Francois

Chair, Townsend
At-Large
Pepperell
Townsend

ALSO PRESENT

Brad Morgan
Nancy Haines
Kevin Cormier
Jeremy Hamond
Robin Eibye

Superintendent of Schools
Business Manager
Asst. Business Manager
Director of Operations
Recording Secretary ~ Absent

CALL MEETING TO ORDER

- Chair, Kym Craven opened the meeting at 8:35 a.m.

Roll Call:			
Kym Craven	Yes	Gary Burboa-Reese	-
Qenan Francois	Yes	Nancy Haines	Yes
Lisa Martin	Yes	Kevin Cormier	Yes
Patrick McPhillips	Yes	Robin Eibye	Yes
Brad Morgan	Yes	Jeremy Hamond	Yes

PUBLIC COMMENT

- None

MINUTES FOR APPROVAL

- None

FY25 BUDGET UPDATE

- Business Manager Nancy Haines reported that the FY25 end-of-year report is in process.
- Haines explained the financial impact of the district's former Health Trust disbanding. The district initially allocated \$1 million (from School Choice Revolving and General Fund) to cover potential run-out claims. A significant portion of those funds was later returned and reallocated appropriately.
- Haines reviewed the School Choice Revolving Fund, noting it is used for health insurance, turf field payments, and designated expenses. She reported that declining school choice enrollments, due to reduced acceptance of new students, may limit the fund's sustainability.
- Members discussed FY25 budget strategies, including reducing reliance on one-time funds to promote long-term sustainability.
- Superintendent Morgan and Haines outlined FY25 actions taken to control spending and replenish Excess & Deficiency (E&D), including:
 - Soft spending freeze
 - Deferral of capital and technology projects
 - Shifting eligible positions to grants
 - Holding select vacancies unfilled
 - Additional cost-saving measures
- Haines provided an update on supplemental funding and town assessments and said the district received \$302,000 in additional state Circuit Breaker reimbursement and additional Chapter 70 funds in FY26 to help offset increased assessments and unanticipated special education costs. Managing Special Education tuitions and transportation remains a significant ongoing challenge.
- Superintendent Morgan agreed to provide a list of FY25 budget reductions.

FY26 BUDGET REVIEW AND UPDATE

- Budget-to-actual updates noted savings in health insurance (opt-out program approximately \$200,000), tuition/transportation, and retirements.
- Fuel/heating costs are projected to exceed the FY26 budget by approximately \$140,000.
- Staffing remains fluid due to open positions; a staffing audit is being planned.
- Deferred capital needs are accumulating for future years.
- Members discussed continued monitoring of FY26 finances and proactive planning for FY27 budget development.

- Jeremy Hamond reviewed capital and technology projects deferred in FY25 due to financial constraints, including Ashby floor repairs, HVAC upgrades, security improvements, Spaulding pathways, Chromebook refresh, classroom projectors, and network switches. Hamond agreed to provide a timeline of delayed capital/technology projects.

NEXT MEETING

- Next meeting scheduled for October 30th at 8:30 a.m.

ADJOURNMENT

- At 9:57 a.m., Lisa Martin moved, and Qenan Francois seconded to adjourn the meeting.

Roll Call Vote:			
Lisa Martin	Yes	Kym Craven	Yes
Patrick McPhillips	Yes	Qenan Francois	Yes

Vote: The motion unanimously passed 4/0/0

Documents Reviewed / Referred to:

- 2025-10-02 Finance Agenda
- 2025-10-02 Finance Packet

Respectfully submitted,
Robin Eibye, Recording Secretary

APPROVED:



NORTH MIDDLESEX REGIONAL SCHOOL DISTRICT

FY26 Budget

by Appropriation Category

11/24/2025

Appropriation Category	FY26 Adopted Budget	FY26 Budget with Requested Transfers	Requested Budget Transfers	Expended/Encumbered	Remaining Unencumbered Balance	Anticipated Expenditures	Remaining Balance	Transfers Previously Approved	Transfers Needed
Administration	\$1,742,612	\$1,711,188	-\$31,424	\$1,451,934	\$259,254	\$219,067	\$40,187	\$0.00	-\$31,424.00
Instructional Support:	\$29,344,703	\$29,106,141	-\$238,562	\$26,665,508	\$2,440,633	\$1,485,612	\$955,020	\$0	-\$238,562.00
<i>Instructional Leadership</i>	\$2,911,733	\$2,823,142	-\$88,591	\$2,512,402	\$310,740	\$353,387	-\$42,648		
<i>Classroom & Specialist Teachers</i>	\$20,550,127	\$20,241,521	-\$308,606	\$19,328,723	\$912,798	\$163,350	\$749,448		
<i>Other Teaching Services</i>	\$4,745,711	\$4,904,346	\$158,635	\$4,486,208	\$418,138	\$227,131	\$191,007		
<i>Professional Development</i>	\$199,050	\$199,050	\$0	\$47,933	\$151,117	\$107,027	\$44,090		
<i>Instructional Materials, Equipment & Technology</i>	\$938,082	\$938,082	\$0	\$290,242	\$647,840	\$634,717	\$13,123		
Pupil Services:	\$5,469,480	\$5,469,480	\$0	\$5,215,769	\$253,710	\$273,146	-\$19,436	\$0.00	\$0.00
<i>Guidance, Counseling & Testing</i>	\$1,702,179	\$1,702,179	\$0	\$1,709,945	-\$7,765	\$43,048	-\$50,813	\$0.00	
<i>Pupil Services</i>	\$3,767,300	\$3,767,300	\$0	\$3,505,825	\$261,476	\$230,098	\$31,377	\$0.00	
Operations, Maintenance & Technology	\$5,148,352	\$5,148,352	\$0	\$4,421,927	\$726,426	\$774,633	-\$48,207	\$0.00	\$0.00
Insurance, Retirement Programs & Oth	\$12,433,505	\$12,405,937	-\$27,568	\$14,825,086	-\$2,419,150	-\$2,740,395	\$321,245	\$0.00	-\$27,568.00
Debt & Transfers	\$3,582,911	\$3,582,911	\$0	\$2,804,361	\$778,550	\$810,727	-\$32,177	\$0.00	\$0.00
Pmts to Out-of District Schools & Assessments	\$9,699,937	\$9,997,491	\$297,554	\$7,266,943	\$2,730,549	\$1,805,089	\$925,460	\$0.00	\$297,554.00
Transfer to OPEB, Capital Project and Stabilization	\$150,000	\$150,000	\$0	\$150,000	\$0	\$0	\$0		
Total General Fund Appropriation	\$67,571,500	\$67,571,500	\$0	\$62,801,528	\$4,769,972	\$2,627,880	\$2,142,093	\$0.00	\$ -



NORTH MIDDLESEX REGIONAL SCHOOL DISTRICT

FY27 BUDGET SUMMIT MEETING

Ashby – Pepperell – Townsend, Massachusetts

NOTES – October 27, 2025

In-person at Varnum Brook Elementary School

PRESENT

Lisa Martin	At-Large
Qenan Francois	Townsend
Brad Morgan	Superintendent of Schools
Gary Burboa-Reese	Assistant Superintendent
Nancy Haines	Business Manager
Kevin Cormier	Asst. Business Manager
Robin Eibye	Recording Secretary
Margaret Scarsdale	State Representative
Andrew MacLean	Pepperell Town Administrator
Chuck Walkovich	Pepperell Selectboard
Nelson Mui	Townsend Town Administrator
Valerie Goodrich	Townsend Selectboard
Mary Daughraty	Ashby Town Administrator
Paul Lasorsa	Ashby Selectboard

FY27 BUDGET DISCUSSION

Town Revenues, Budget Challenges, Debt, and Development

- Pepperell Revenue Overview – A. MacLean
Pepperell Town Administrator Andrew MacLean presented a draft of Pepperell's Five-Year General Fund Revenue Projection. He reported:
 - Approximately 80% of Pepperell's revenue comes from the property tax levy, with the remainder from state aid and local receipts.
 - The projected FY26 property tax levy is \$ 30.867 million.
 - Total projected general fund revenue is \$38,381,000, with \$34,991,000 available after exclusions for debt and other commitments.

- Growth is constrained by Proposition 2½ limits on levy increases and modest state/local revenue growth (approximately 2% annually).
- MacLean noted that excluded debt, such as the \$1.8 million high school project bond, does not impact available operating funds.
- Revenue Constraints and Overrides
 - Town administrators agreed that tax overrides are politically challenging, and available revenue sources are limited.
 - Townsend has not passed an override in 20 years, according to Town Administrator Nelson Mui.
 - Salary and health insurance costs are expected to rise across towns and will consume a significant portion of the available new revenue.
 - Development Impact – Pepperell
 - MacLean reported two proposed housing developments in Pepperell (180 apartments and 45 condominiums), which may yield additional tax revenue and an estimated 62 new students for NMRSD.
 - New revenue from these developments is not expected until fiscal year 2029.

District Budget Challenges – NMRSD

- Superintendent Brad Morgan and School Committee Chair Lisa Martin highlighted:
 - Large class sizes and staffing pressures, with concern that further reductions could affect educational quality.
 - Special education costs, out-of-district placements, health insurance, and inflationary costs continue to drive expenses.
 - Approximately 30% of NMRSD students receive special education services, a rate significantly higher than the state average (the 30% includes students with 504 plans).
 - The closure of Ashby Elementary School generated savings; however, additional school closures would create growth and configuration challenges.
 - Mary Daughraty asked why the district was not considering closing another school to reduce costs and lower the budget. Superintendent Morgan stated that he did not support additional school closures due to space limitations and the needs of students. Closing another building would leave no room for growth. He did add that he would look into it, as it was explored last year.

State Funding Formula and Advocacy

- Members discussed structural funding deficits due to:

- State aid formulas that do not reflect rising costs.
- Circuit breaker reimbursement and transportation aid do not keep pace with the rising costs of special education.
- Health insurance and inflationary costs are increasing faster than revenue.
- While funding formula reform is widely acknowledged as necessary, implementing legislative changes is expected to take several years.
- The district and towns will continue to advocate for legislative funding equity.

Regionalization and Shared Services

- The group discussed shared services and regional partnerships as cost-saving strategies.
 - Areas under consideration include central office functions with neighboring districts, fire services, inspectional services, animal control, and potentially DPW.
 - Collaboration with neighboring districts and towns is ongoing, though implementation challenges limit immediate savings.
 - Regionalization may provide incremental relief but will not fully resolve fiscal pressures.

Communication and Community Engagement

- Participants discussed the importance of:
 - Consistent and unified messaging to maintain community trust.
 - Public forums and community education to improve understanding of financial challenges.
 - Sharing accurate and verified financial data to avoid confusion.
 - Preparing executive summaries and clear reports for transparency.

ACTION ITEMS

Item	Responsible Party
Provide Townsend Five-Year General Fund Revenue Projection	Nelson Mui
Provide Ashby Five-Year General Fund Revenue Projection	Mary Daughraty
Prepare an executive summary on the housing development impact	Andrew MacLean
Continue evaluation of regionalization/shared services options	District & Town Administrators

Item	Responsible Party
Invite State Representative Chuck Walkovich to the next Finance Committee meeting on October 30, 2025.	District Administration
Invite Senator John Cronin to the next Budget Summit on November 17	District Administration

Next Budget Summit: November 17th at North Middlesex Regional High School

DRAFT



NORTH MIDDLESEX REGIONAL SCHOOL DISTRICT

FY27 BUDGET SUMMIT MEETING

Ashby – Pepperell – Townsend, Massachusetts

NOTES – November 17, 2025

In-person at North Middlesex Regional High School

PRESENT

Kym Craven	NMRSD FinCom, Chair
Brad Morgan	Superintendent of Schools
Gary Burboa-Reese	Assistant Superintendent
Nancy Haines	Business Manager
Kevin Cormier	Asst. Business Manager
Robin Eibye	Recording Secretary
Andrew MacLean	Pepperell Town Administrator
Chuck Walkovich	Pepperell Selectboard
Nelson Mui	Townsend Town Administrator
Valerie Goodrich	Townsend Selectboard
Kathy Spofford	Townsend FinCom
Jerrilyn Bozicas	Townsend FinCom, Vice-Chair
Mary Daughraty	Ashby Town Administrator
Paul Lasorsa	Ashby Selectboard
Susan Templeton	Office of State Senator John J. Cronin

FY27 Revenue & Budget Projections

Nancy Haines presented a draft FY27 revenue projection based on a 3% budget increase. State aid was estimated at \$60 per student, though the final amount may range from \$30–\$150 depending on the state budget and the Governor’s proposal.

Town Assessments & State Aid

Minimum required contributions for member towns will influence how local assessments are allocated but do not affect Chapter 70 funding levels. Current estimates project a 3.94% increase in town assessments.

Final town-by-town assessment breakdowns and pupil counts will be updated once the Governor releases the January budget proposal, including adjustments for school choice-in and choice-out students.

Excess & Deficiency Funds

The School Committee has not yet determined the amount of E&D to apply toward the FY27 budget. A draft reserve policy is under development, recommending the district maintain a 3–4% reserve.

Building Utilization

The district is reviewing potential costs and operational considerations related to reopening Ashby. Members also discussed significant unused space across current facilities and explored options for classroom reallocations and responding to shifting enrollment.

Long-Term Facilities Strategy

Modular classrooms were discussed as a potential cost-effective and quickly deployable solution for addressing enrollment pressures and space needs.

Budget Challenges

Andrew MacLean shared two revenue handouts and noted that preliminary projections show a \$64,000 deficit at 3% budget growth compared to a \$1.5 million deficit at 5%. A discussion followed regarding rising health insurance and retirement costs, which continue to strain both town and district budgets and signal the likelihood of difficult financial decisions ahead.

Grants & State Funding

Superintendent Morgan provided an update, noting that the district continues to pursue additional grant opportunities, including Career Technical Education (CTE) pilot grants and MSBA grant extensions. He expressed disappointment regarding the delay in pilot grants program.

Regionalization

The group discussed the ongoing value of exploring regionalized services across municipalities.

Superintendent Morgan said the preliminary FY27 budget would be shared once departmental submissions are complete, likely after Thanksgiving. Additional discussion is expected at the December School Committee meeting.

Action Items

Andrew MacLean will send the FY27 revenue projection documents electronically to Nancy Haines and Robin Eibye and include additional explanatory notes.

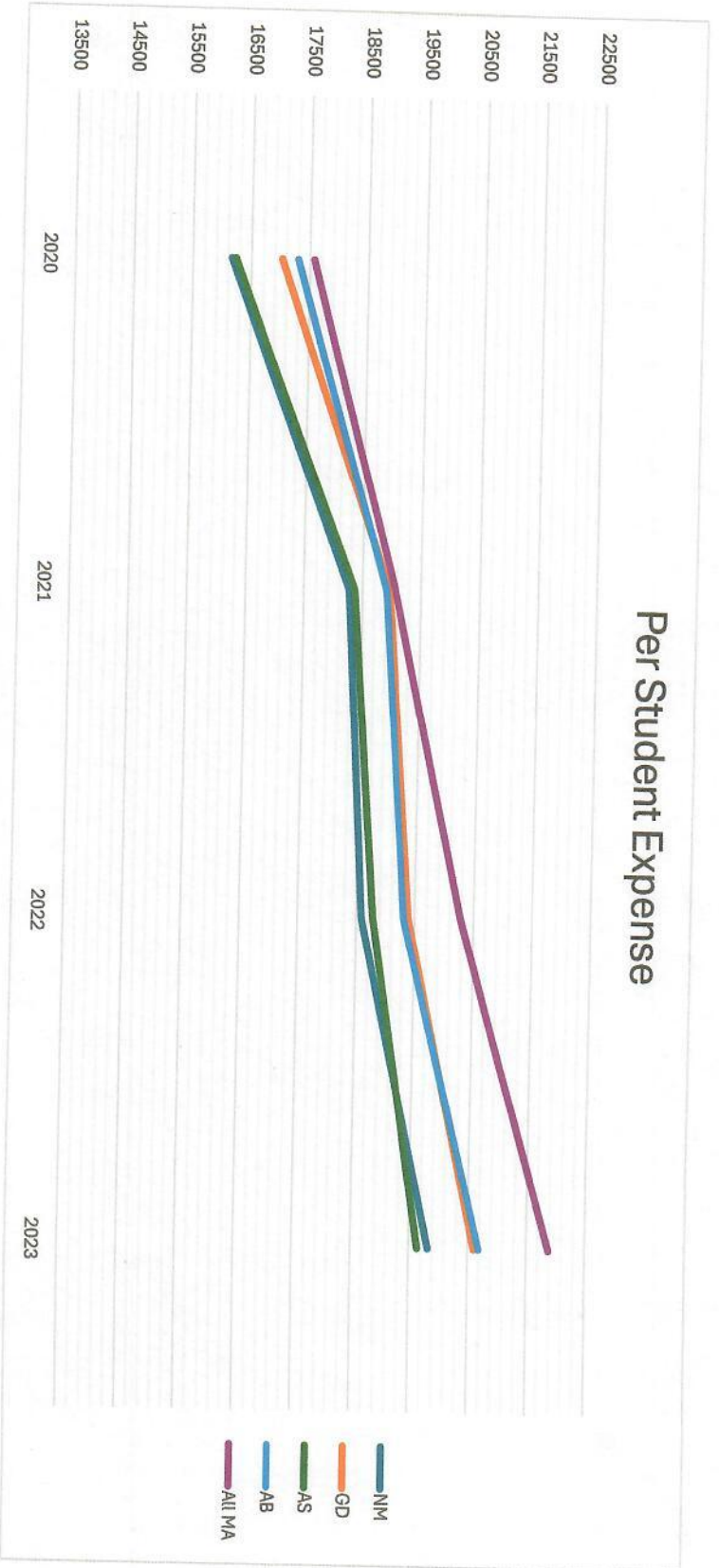
DRAFT

Pepperell Five Year General Fund Revenue Projection

FOX NH 3

Sources of Revenue	FY2026	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029	FY2030	FY2031
Tax Levy Limit	28,050,275	28,978,793	29,920,604	30,893,023	31,897,047	32,933,701
Amended New Growth from previous year	-189	0	0	0	0	0
2.5% allowed annual increase	701,252	724,470	748,015	772,326	797,426	823,343
Tax Override (TM vote to increase levy)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Use of Free Cash to support operations	0	0	0	0	0	0
New Growth	227,455	217,341	224,405	231,698	239,228	247,003
	28,978,793	29,920,604	30,893,023	31,897,047	32,933,701	34,004,046
Total Debt Exclusions	1,889,006	1,889,006	1,889,006	1,889,006	1,889,006	1,889,006
Total taxation and available funds	30,867,799	31,809,609	32,782,029	33,786,052	34,822,706	35,893,052
State Aid - FY2026 07/01/2025	FY2026	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029	FY2030	FY2031
Unrestricted Gen. Government Aid (UGGA)	1,857,995	1,895,155	1,933,058	1,971,719	2,011,154	2,051,377
Veterans	64,232	65,517	66,827	68,164	69,527	70,917
VBS and Elderly	129,397	131,985	134,625	137,317	140,063	142,865
State owned Land	77,194	78,738	80,313	81,919	83,557	85,228
Library Grant - Does NOT get added to GF	33,455	34,124	34,807	35,503	36,213	36,937
Offset receipts (air poll, RMV, reg. transit)	-31,101	(31,723)	(32,357)	(33,005)	(33,665)	(34,338)
Net State Aid from Cherry Sheets	2,097,717	2,139,671	2,182,465	2,226,114	2,270,636	2,316,049
Local Receipts	FY2026	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029	FY2030	FY2031
Total Estimated Local Receipts	5,416,071.97	5,554,712	5,682,665	5,813,675	5,947,819	6,085,176
Total General Fund Revenue	38,381,588	39,503,993	40,647,158	41,825,842	43,041,162	44,294,276
Available (less debt, less PRECC)	34,991,751	36,069,131	37,165,921	38,296,837	39,462,958	40,665,396
Split between Town and Schools adjusts annual with MRC and enrollments	FY2026	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029	FY2030	FY2031
Town	13,494,254	13,909,736	14,332,703	14,768,831	15,218,535	15,682,244
NMRSD	19,365,450	19,961,703	20,568,699	21,194,580	21,839,945	22,505,409
NVTHS	2,132,047	2,197,692	2,264,520	2,333,426	2,404,478	2,477,743
NMRSD anticipated increase	\$ 596,253	\$ 606,995	\$ 625,882	\$ 645,365	\$ 665,464	
Whole District	\$ 1,192,507	\$ 1,213,991	\$ 1,251,764	\$ 1,290,730	\$ 1,330,928	

Per Student Expense



Revenue

	FY2026			FY2026	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029
	Townsend	Ashby	Pepperell	Combined	Projected		
Total Levy	\$ 22,275,722	\$ 8,355,657	\$ 28,978,987	\$ 59,610,366	\$ 61,100,625	\$ 62,628,141	\$ 64,193,844
New Growth	111,379	8,356	217,342	\$ 337,077	\$ 345,504	\$ 354,141	\$ 362,995
State Aid	\$ 2,136,746	\$ 791,000	\$ 2,139,671	\$ 6,883,536	\$ 7,021,206	\$ 7,161,630	\$ 7,304,863
Local Receipts	\$ 3,210,000	\$ 994,000	\$ 3,955,790	\$ 8,159,790	\$ 7,955,785	\$ 8,114,901	\$ 8,277,199
Total Local Revenue	\$ 27,733,847	\$10,149,013	\$ 35,291,790	\$ 73,174,649	\$ 74,877,264	\$ 76,666,582	\$ 78,498,902
Excluded Debt	\$ 1,335,943	\$ -	\$ 1,889,006	\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949
Total Levy with debt	\$ 28,958,411	\$10,140,657	\$ 36,963,454	\$ 76,399,598	\$ 78,102,213	\$ 79,891,531	\$ 81,723,851
Y/Y not including Ex. Debt.					2.33%	2.39%	2.39%
RECC					\$ 1,041,855	\$ 1,042,732	\$ 1,043,906

Expenses

General Fund	\$ 27,592,926	\$10,140,657	\$ 35,025,206	\$ 72,758,789	\$ 74,941,553	\$ 77,189,799	\$ 79,505,493
Excluded Debt	\$ 1,335,943	\$ -	\$ 1,889,006	\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949
General Fund and Ex. Debt	\$ 28,928,869	\$10,140,657	\$ 36,914,212	\$ 75,983,738	\$ 78,166,502	\$ 80,414,748	\$ 82,730,442

Net surplus (deficit) \$ 29,542 \$ - \$ 49,242 \$ 78,784 \$ (64,288) \$ (523,218) \$ (1,006,591)

Combined - weighted

New Growth Factor 0.500% 0.10% 0.75% 0.565%

Pepperell total does not include non-Pepperell Patriot RECC revenues as they would be double counted.

Expenses are shown at 3% and growth is projecting below that.
 We know health insurance will be higher than that.
 Wages with step/COLA will be higher than 3%
 Retirement payments are above 6%.

3%

FY2030	FY2031
--------	--------

Notes

\$ 65,798,690	\$ 67,443,658	Includes 2.5% increase, new growth, overrides.
\$ 372,070	\$ 381,371	Combined growth factor is .565%
\$ 7,450,960	\$ 7,599,979	2.0% annual increase assumed
\$ 8,442,743	\$ 8,611,598	2.0% annual increase assumed
\$ 80,375,265	\$ 82,296,732	
\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949	Excluded debt, Town and School, added to levy
\$ 83,600,214	\$ 85,521,681	
2.39%	2.39%	
\$ 1,515,394		
\$ 2,050,646		

\$ 81,890,658	\$ 84,347,378
\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949
\$ 85,115,607	\$ 87,572,327

This should match line for debt in revenue

\$ (1,515,394) \$ (2,050,646)

Revenue	FY2026			FY2026	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029
	Townsend	Ashby	Pepperell	Combined	Projected		
Total Levy	\$ 22,275,722	\$ 8,355,657	\$ 28,978,987	\$ 59,610,366	\$ 61,100,625	\$ 62,628,141	\$ 64,193,844
New Growth	111,379	8,356	217,342	\$ 337,077	\$ 345,504	\$ 354,141	\$ 362,995
State Aid	\$ 2,136,746	\$ 791,000	\$ 2,139,671	\$ 6,883,536	\$ 7,021,206	\$ 7,161,630	\$ 7,304,863
Local Receipts	\$ 3,210,000	\$ 994,000	\$ 3,955,790	\$ 8,159,790	\$ 7,955,785	\$ 8,114,901	\$ 8,277,199
Total Local Revenue	\$ 27,733,847	\$ 10,149,013	\$ 35,291,790	\$ 73,174,649	\$ 74,877,264	\$ 76,666,582	\$ 78,498,902
Excluded Debt	\$ 1,335,943	\$ -	\$ 1,889,006	\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949
Total Levy with debt	\$ 28,958,411	\$ 10,140,657	\$ 36,963,454	\$ 76,399,598	\$ 78,102,213	\$ 79,891,531	\$ 81,723,851
Y/Y not including Ex. Debt.					2.33%	2.39%	2.39%
PECC					\$ 1,045,835	\$ 1,087,732	\$ 1,039,999

				105.00%
				5% across the board for this version.
Expenses				
General Fund	\$ 27,592,926	\$ 10,140,657	\$ 35,025,206	\$ 72,758,789
Excluded Debt	\$ 1,335,943	\$ -	\$ 1,889,006	\$ 3,224,949
General Fund and Ex. Debt	\$ 28,928,869	\$ 10,140,657	\$ 36,914,212	\$ 75,983,738
Net surplus (deficit)	\$ 29,542	\$ -	\$ 49,242	\$ 78,784
				\$ (1,519,464) \$ (3,549,983) \$ (5,728,491)

Combined - weighted

New Growth Factor 0.500% 0.10% 0.75% 0.565%

Pepperell total does not include non-Pepperell Patriot RECC revenues as they would be double counted.

Expenses are shown at 3% and growth is projecting below that.
 We know health insurance will be higher than that.
 Wages with step/COLA will be higher than 3%
 Retirement payments are above 6%.

5%

FY2030	FY2031
--------	--------

Notes

\$ 65,798,690	\$ 67,443,658	Includes 2.5% increase, new growth, overrides.
\$ 372,070	\$ 381,371	Combined growth factor is .565%
\$ 7,450,960	\$ 7,599,979	2.0% annual increase assumed
\$ 8,442,743	\$ 8,611,598	2.0% annual increase assumed
\$ 80,375,265	\$ 82,296,732	
\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949	Excluded debt, Town and School, added to levy
\$ 83,600,214	\$ 85,521,681	
2.39%	2.39%	
\$ 10,563,969		
\$ 10,563,969		

\$ (8,063,498) \$ (10,563,969)

\$ 88,438,763	\$ 92,860,701	
\$ 3,224,949	\$ 3,224,949	This should match line for debt in revenue
\$ 91,663,712	\$ 96,085,650	



Eibye, Robin <reibye@nmrsd.org>

TAP Five year v2.xlsx

1 message

Andrew MacLean <AMacLean@town.pepperell.ma.us>

Mon, Nov 17, 2025 at 12:58 PM

To: "nmui@townsendma.gov" <nmui@townsendma.gov>, Mary Daugherty <mdaugherty@ashbysma.gov>

Cc: "Haines, Nancy" <nhaines@nmrsd.org>, "reibye@nmrsd.org" <reibye@nmrsd.org>, "Martin, Lisa" <lmartin@nmrsd.org>

Hi –

Attached is the document we reviewed briefly this morning. Please share with today's attendees, I'm not certain I have all their emails.

I have changed the formatting but not the content.

- Explanations of assumptions appear at the top instead of far right and bottom. This allows single page printing.
- Red box in center can be changed to a different expense rate and the projection will update.
- Town and Schools need to be in sync with debt. Excluded debt is ADDED to the levy so if it increases or decreases it creates a false sense of financial need.
 - Moving forward, I recommend we show revenue WITHOUT excluded debts.
 - The three towns are currently projecting growth below 3%. The schools are showing operations at 3.11% and overall at 3% (with debt).
- The towns have asked the that school *operating assessments* be kept to our growth rate, currently estimated at 2.3%. The schools are currently projecting a 3.94% increase in the assessment and this is with debt included so the operating assessment is higher.

I keep thinking there is an error in the formula but cannot find it. Please let me know if you notice anything misrepresented and we will correct it.

Andrew



TAP Five year v2.xlsx

24K

NMRSD District Staffing Profile
Staffing Analysis by F.T.E -FY27 DRAFT

	2018-2019	2019-2020	2020-2021	2021-2022	2021-2022	2022-2023	2023-2024	2024-2025	FY25-26	FY2026 Current	FY26-27	Change
	Budget	Budget	Budget	Budget	Budget	Budget	Budget	Budget	Budget	FTE	**DRAFT**	Over FY26
School Based Staff												
Principals	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	7.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	0.00
Assistant Principals	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	5.00	5.50	4.50	4.50	4.50	0.00
Guidance / Social Workers	13.50	13.00	14.00	14.00	14.00	16.00	15.00	14.00	14.00	14.00	14.00	0.00
Psychologist	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00	0.00
Health Services	8.20	9.20	8.60	8.60	8.60	9.80	9.80	9.80	8.60	9.40	9.40	0.80
Secretaries	10.88	10.75	10.75	10.75	10.75	10.75	9.75	10.00	10.00	10.00	10.00	0.00
Media Research Specialist (formerly library)	5.40	5.40	5.40	5.40	5.40	5.40	1.20	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	0.00
Athletic Director/Trainer	2.00	2.00	2.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.50	1.50	1.50	1.50	0.00
Teaching												
Regular Teachers	179.80	178.00	178.40	175.20	173.20	168.70	166.20	167.20	150.50	150.00	148.20	-2.30
Special Ed Teachers	53.80	53.80	54.50	56.60	56.60	55.50	54.50	58.50	58.63	55.00	54.63	-4.00
Specialist Teachers	10.19	10.09	10.36	8.59	8.59	8.46	8.46	12.46	12.46	15.80	14.46	2.00
DWS Team Leader & Curriculum Directors	0.00	0.00	0.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.00	1.50	1.85	1.00	2.00	0.15
Theraputic/Medical	17.10	17.70	17.20	16.40	16.40	16.40	17.40	18.20	19.80	17.80	18.20	-1.60
Tutors & Aids												
Regular	32.30	34.00	34.00	34.00	34.00	32.79	35.14	26.29	26.14	23.09	29.00	2.86
Special Education	52.50	40.00	49.50	49.50	46.50	48.50	48.50	51.50	50.96	51.74	55.00	4.04
District Wide Staff												
Central Office	12.20	13.20	14.20	14.20	14.20	14.20	14.00	15.00	15.00	14.60	15.00	0.00
School Resource Officer/Crossing guard	5.00	5.00	5.00	5.00	5.00	7.00	7.00	7.00	6.00	4.00	4.00	-2.00
Technology Staff & Director	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	6.00	0.00
Custodians & Director	29.70	30.20	31.50	31.50	31.50	32.50	33.50	33.50	30.50	29.42	32.00	1.50
Total FTE - General Fund	454.56	444.34	457.41	455.74	450.74	452.00	446.45	450.95	429.44	420.85	430.89	1.45
Contracted Staff (OT, SLP, TVI)										2.50	2.5	
New Positions Behavior Tech(2) & ETL Admin (1)										3.00	3	
Gen Fund total										426.35	436.39	

Staffing Analysis by F.T.E

	FY2026											
	2018-2019	2019-2020	2020-2021	2021-2022	2021-2022	2022-2023	2023-2024	2024-2025	2025-2026	Current	FY26-27	Change Over
<u>Grant/Revolving Funded Positions</u>	<u>Budget</u>	<u>Budget</u>	<u>Budget</u>	<u>Budget</u>	<u>Budget</u>	<u>Budget</u>	<u>Budget</u>	<u>Budget</u>	<u>Budget</u>	<u>FTE</u>	<u>**DRAFT**</u>	<u>FY26 Budget</u>
Sped Allocation Grant 240	33.00	34.00	30.00	30.00	30.00	31.50	32.00	33.00	31.50	27.00	30.00	-1.50
SPED IDEA Para Grant					n/a	4.35	0.00	0.00	-		-	0.00
Early Childhood Grant - Paraprofessional 262	0.40	1.50	1.50	1.50	2.00	1.65	1.65	1.65	1.65	1.26	1.26	-0.39
Title I Grant - Teachers/ Interventionists/admin	3.50	3.50	2.50	2.50	7.00	3.00	7.00	7.00	7.00	9.80	9.80	2.80
Title IV A, ML										1.00		0.00
Preschool Revolving Fund - Teachers 069	1.00	1.00	1.50	1.50	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00
Tuition Revolving Fund 028	1.00	1.00	3.00	3.00	1.50	1.50	1.50	2.50	2.50	3.00	3.00	0.50
Keystone Rental Revolving	1.00	1.30	1.00	1.00	1.50	2.50	1.50	2.50	1.50	0.50	-	-1.50
ESSER II & III					25.85	14.00	13.25	8.00	-	-	-	0.00
State Health Services Grant 367										0.40	0.40	0.40
Before & After School Revolving Program					n/a	10.00	14.00	14.00	14.00	2.00	14.00	0.00
Total FTE - Grant Funded	36.90	42.30	39.50	39.50	68.85	69.50	71.90	69.65	59.15	45.96	59.46	0.31
District Total	491.46	486.64	496.91	495.24	519.59	521.50	518.35	520.60	488.59	472.31	490.35	1.76

Fiscal Reserves

A financial reserve policy is a means of ensuring the long-term financial health and flexibility of the North Middlesex Regional School District, as well as a tool to support the District's financial decision-making. Financial rating agencies currently recommend that local governments maintain strong and varied financial reserves of up to 8% of the total General Fund Operating Budget (excluding the OPEB fund).

Financial reserve policies cover various classes of reserve funds intended to provide for unanticipated expenses (contingency funds) and to supplement the General Fund Operating Budget.

- Operating reserves, which provide resources for unanticipated expenditures or unexpected revenue losses during the year;
- Capital Reserves, which provide resources for the repair, replacement, or construction of capital infrastructure.
- OPEB Reserves, which provide for funding of the other post-employment benefit liability.

The District is committed to establishing and maintaining varied reserves that provide for stability and predictability in our financial planning. The District will maintain the following reserve funds and contribute to and maintain these funds as outlined below.

The NMRSD School Committee understands that the budget is a good faith contract with the community members from each town. Therefore, the district will strive to create a budget, and fully use those appropriations, that is consistent with the student's best interest in mind. If the EOY balance on any budget exceeds \$500,000, it should trigger an examination of the current year's budget for any necessary adjustments.

The NMRSD School Committee believes that the budget should be prepared for known expenses, with reserve funds used for unanticipated expenses. Therefore, if the EOY balance on any budget exceeds \$500,000 in unexpended expenses, it should trigger an examination of the current year's budget for areas that should be reduced.

Excess & Deficiency (E&D) – Reserve Class: Operating and Capital

The available E&D balance is calculated and certified each year by the Massachusetts Department of Revenue, Division of Local Services using data submitted by the District. Increases to the E&D balance on an annual basis consist of revenues exceeding budgeted amounts, as well as unspent appropriations. While the allowable use of E&D, by statute, is largely unrestricted; sound financial practice suggests that this reserve provides for the

financing of unforeseen, emergency needs such as unanticipated operating or capital costs or loss of revenue and should not be used regularly as a revenue source in future budgets.

Current legislation limits the District's E&D balance to a maximum of 5% of the District's total General Fund Operating Budget. It is recommended that we maintain between 3 - 4% E&D balance to protect against unforeseen costs. The School Committee may consider budgeting anything in excess of the 3% for:

- Additional investment in the Stabilization or OPEB reserve accounts.
- One-time purchases.
- **Planned future one time expenditures (must be documented),**
- **Support pilot program costs.**
- **Phasing in of new initiatives.**
- Payment toward town debt principal.
- Applied as funding toward the current year budget
- Applied as funding source for the following year's budget
- Other needed use.

The NMRSD School Committee, on occasion, may approve by a two-thirds vote the use of existing E&D Funds as additional revenue within a current fiscal year in order to cover unanticipated revenue shortfalls or to fund non-recurring or unforeseen expenditures that are deemed as either extraordinary or unavoidable by District Administration and the School Committee. Any vote to increase the current year Budget through the use of E&D Funds is considered an increase to the district budget and shall be submitted to all member Towns for approval in accordance with DESE regulations.

Capital Stabilization Fund – Reserve Class: Capital

A Capital Stabilization Fund is a reserve allowable by Massachusetts General Laws (MGL) Chapter 71, Section 16G ½ to provide the District with the ability to accumulate resources for any purpose in which the District could otherwise borrow funds, as well as any other lawful purpose upon approval of the Massachusetts Department of Revenue, Division of Local Services. Capital stabilization funds may be used to finance capital activities as well as cover unanticipated one-time Capital needs. The District shall maintain a Capital Stabilization fund in accordance with MGL Chapter 71, Section 16G ½. Additionally, it is the intention of the District that the Capital Stabilization Fund be funded by certified available excess E&D above the 3% recommended minimum balance, one-time revenues, and/or a line item in the District's General Fund Operating Budget. In an effort to accumulate resources within the Capital Stabilization Fund, the District may include a line item within the General Fund Operating Budget for appropriation annually until the maximum limit is reached. It is the intention of the School Committee that the Capital Stabilization shall not be further funded once it exceeds 10% of the District's prior year's Total General Fund appropriations **with the exception of planned documented savings for a specific one time purpose.** . This fund shall be considered, in addition to funding special capital projects, the reserve (contingency) fund for all unanticipated capital

expenses and it shall not be common practice to include contingency capital expenses within general operating budget lines except for planned capital projects.

Other Post-Employment Benefits (OPEB) – Reserve Class: Other Post Employment Benefits

The District currently maintains an irrevocable Other Post-Employment Benefits Trust Fund in accordance with MGL 32B Section 20, for the purpose of accumulating resources to provide legally required retiree health insurance benefits. The objective of the OPEB Trust fund is to accumulate assets to fully fund the actuarially calculated liability of providing these future health insurance benefits. It is in the best financial interest of the District that the OPEB Trust Fund balance not be withdrawn until the point in time at which the actuarially calculated OPEB liability is fully funded. In an effort to accumulate resources within the OPEB Trust Fund, the School Committee may include a contribution to the OPEB Trust in the general fund budget annually until fully funded.

LEGAL REFERENCES: MGL 32B Section 20 MGL Chapter 71, Section 16B ½
MGL Chapter 71, Section 16G ½

CROSS REFERENCES: None

Adopted by the School Committee:

NMRSD Adoption:

Five-Year Review:

Policy Subcommittee Review: October 21, 2025

NMRSD First Vote:

NMRSD Adoption:

Fiscal Reserves

A financial reserve policy is a means of ensuring the long-term financial health and flexibility of the North Middlesex Regional School District, as well as a tool to support the District's financial decision-making. Financial rating agencies currently recommend that local governments maintain strong and varied financial reserves.

Financial reserve policies cover various classes of reserve funds intended to provide for unanticipated expenses (contingency funds) and to supplement the General Fund Operating Budget.

- Operating reserves, which provide resources for unanticipated expenditures or unexpected revenue losses during the year;
- Capital Reserves, which provide resources for the repair, replacement, or construction of capital infrastructure.
- OPEB Reserves, which provide for funding of the other post-employment benefit liability.

The District is committed to establishing and maintaining varied reserves that provide for stability and predictability in our financial planning. The District will maintain the following reserve funds and contribute to and maintain these funds as outlined below.

Excess & Deficiency (E&D) – Reserve Class: Operating and Capital

The available E&D balance is calculated and certified each year by the Massachusetts Department of Revenue, Division of Local Services using data submitted by the District. Increases to the E&D balance on an annual basis consist of revenues exceeding budgeted amounts, as well as unspent appropriations. While the allowable use of E&D, by statute, is largely unrestricted; sound financial practice suggests that this reserve provides for the financing of unforeseen, emergency needs such as unanticipated operating or capital costs or loss of revenue. ~~It is the expectation of the NMRSD School Committee that E&D and~~ should not be used regularly as a revenue source in future ~~operating~~ budgets.

Current legislation limits the District's E&D balance to a maximum of 5% of the District's total General Fund Operating Budget. It is recommended that we maintain between 3 - 4% E&D balance to protect against unforeseen costs. The School Committee may consider, ~~upon~~ ~~recommendation of the Superintendent,~~ budgeting anything in excess of the 3% for:

- Additional investment in the Stabilization or OPEB reserve accounts.
- One-time purchases.
- Applied as funding source for the following year's budget.
- Other needed use.

The NMRSD School Committee, on occasion, may approve by a two-thirds vote the use of existing E&D Funds as additional revenue within a current fiscal year in order to cover

unanticipated revenue shortfalls or to fund non-recurring or unforeseen expenditures that are deemed as either extraordinary or unavoidable by District Administration and the School Committee. Any vote to increase the current year Budget through the use of E&D Funds is considered an increase to the district budget and shall be submitted to all member Towns for approval in accordance with DESE regulations.

Capital Stabilization Fund – Reserve Class: Capital

A Capital Stabilization Fund is a reserve allowable by Massachusetts General Laws (MGL) Chapter 71, Section 16G ½ to provide the District with the ability to accumulate resources for any purpose in which the District could otherwise borrow funds, as well as any other lawful purpose upon approval of the Massachusetts Department of Revenue, Division of Local Services. Capital stabilization funds may be used to finance capital activities as well as cover unanticipated one-time Capital needs. The District shall maintain a Capital Stabilization fund in accordance with MGL Chapter 71, Section 16G ½. Additionally, it is the intention of the District that the Capital Stabilization Fund be funded by certified available excess E&D above the 3% recommended minimum balance, one-time revenues, and/or a line item in the District's General Fund Operating Budget. In an effort to accumulate resources within the Capital Stabilization Fund, the District may include a line item within the General Fund Operating Budget for appropriation annually until the maximum limit is reached. It is the intention of the School Committee that the Capital Stabilization shall not be further funded once it exceeds 10% of the District's prior year's Total General Fund appropriations with the exception of planned documented savings for a specific one time purpose. This fund shall be considered, in addition to funding special capital projects, the reserve (contingency) fund for all unanticipated capital expenses and it shall not be common practice to include contingency capital expenses within general operating budget lines except for planned capital projects.

Other Post-Employment Benefits (OPEB) – Reserve Class: Other Post Employment Benefits

The District currently maintains an irrevocable Other Post-Employment Benefits Trust Fund in accordance with MGL 32B Section 20, for the purpose of accumulating resources to provide legally required retiree health insurance benefits. The objective of the OPEB Trust fund is to accumulate assets to fully fund the actuarially calculated liability of providing these future health insurance benefits. It is in the best financial interest of the District that the OPEB Trust Fund balance not be withdrawn until the point in time at which the actuarially calculated OPEB liability is fully funded. In an effort to accumulate resources within the OPEB Trust Fund, the School Committee may include a contribution to the OPEB Trust in the general fund budget annually until fully funded.

LEGAL REFERENCES: MGL 32B Section 20 MGL Chapter 71, Section 16B ½
MGL Chapter 71, Section 16G ½

CROSS REFERENCES: None